work, more so if he happens to be a junior. We shall take some time to be ready for that.

We must begin first with an *inclusive and substantive integration* of the ministry of defence with the service HQs at the policy formulation and planning level, and going down to the theatre commands. There must be cross postings that would ensure meaningful integration on a functional basis, so as to include officers of the three services, officials of the ministries of defence, home, external affairs and finance and others as required, on the same lines as is the practice in other major democracies. Without this being in place, we would be handicapped as far as an integrated response to national security challenges is concerned. It is about time that the 'we' and 'they' syndrome is unshackled.

At the same time, we must create *an effective integrated military hierarchy*, with officers at the higher levels who have been exposed to conditions in other services and various theatres of our country and abroad. For example, high-calibre officers of the three services must be exposed to things like life in a submarine, the freezing Himalayan border areas, the tropical forests of the northeast, the desert of Rajasthan and so on. Finally, and importantly, such officers must also have a clear vision of the big picture at the national level, with an exposure in the ministry of defence, or the service HQs. I have come across some brigadiers and major generals who haven't been out of the country even once. As the chief, I desired that selected brigadiers and above should be given an opportunity to travel abroad at least once, so that they could learn by seeing things first-hand. Then alone, in due course of time, can one hope to become a useful 'single-point adviser'. This process of capacity building can start without delay.

Therefore, in the next ten to fifteen years, we should create integrated theatre commands and specialized commands – such as training and doctrine, aerospace, network-centric warfare and joint logistics in addition to the existing Andaman and Nicobar and Strategic Forces Commands. Cross attachment and posting of middle- and senior-level leadership and tri-service training, war games and courses could commence from 2013. At the theatre or